

Robert McKercher

Economics Ph.D. Candidate | McMaster University

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Public Economics | Experimental Economics | Labour Economics | Taxation | Migration

EDUCATION

Ph.D. Economics	2027*
McMaster University	
M.A. Economics	2021
McMaster University	
B.A. Honour's Economics with Research Specialization and Minor in Global Studies	2019
Wilfrid Laurier University	

AWARDS GRANTS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

David S. Daly Academic Grant	2025-2026
Ontario Graduate Scholarship	2024-2025
General Bursary	2023-2024 & 2024-2025
McMaster Economics Grad Scholarship	2020-2025

WORKING PAPERS

Restricting Tax Planning: Responses across the Income Distribution
Job Market Paper

Should I Stay or Should I Go? The Impact of Taxation on Canadian Inter-Provincial Migration
With Adam Lavecchia and Alisa Tazhitdinova
Reject and Resubmit at Journal of Public Economics (July, 2026)

The Impact of Government Social Spending on the Elasticity of Taxable Income

Labour Supply Responses to Marginal Tax Rates, Average Tax Rates, and Tax Progressivity
With Li-Hsin Lin

Poverty and Income Security in Canada: Designing a Canada-Wide Guaranteed Basic Income Using the PEI Proposal
With Robin Boadway, Kourtney Koebel, and Wayne Simpson

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Should I Stay or Should I Go? The Impact of Taxation on Canadian Inter-Provincial Migration
Canadian Economic Association Annual Conference, Vancouver, British Columbia: May 28th – May 30th, 2026

The Impact of Government Social Spending on the Elasticity of Taxable Income

EMPLOYMENT

Research assistant to Kourtney Koebel September 2026-Present
University of Toronto

Simulate the effects of different policies using SPSS/M

Instructor Winter 2025
McMaster University

Intermediate Microeconomics II (EC2ZZ3)

Research assistant to Adam Lavecchia 2021-2025
McMaster University

Prepare data for, and conduct, analysis for various research projects

Research assistant to Siha Lee Spring - Fall 2023
McMaster University

Prepare data for, and conduct, analysis using the Survey of Labour and Income Dynamics (SLID)

Research assistant to Bradley Ruffle Summer 2022
McMaster University

Responsible for creating detailed summaries of papers exploring income inequality in an experimental setting

Teaching assistant Fall 2020 – Present
McMaster University

Courses covered (one or more times)

Introductory Microeconomics (EC1B03)

Introductory Macroeconomics (EC1BB3)

Intermediate Microeconomics I (EC2Z03)

Intermediate Microeconomics II (EC2ZZ3)

Environmental Economics (EC2J03)

Public Sector Economics: Taxation (EC3C03)

International Monetary Economics (EC3H03)

Labour Economics (EC3D03)

Behavioural Economics (EC3BE3)

TECHNICAL SKILLS

STATA | Fortran | Python | RStudio